



This budget document outlines all recurring costs required to host and operate the AEF HRM System as a fully functional enterprise application for Africa Eye Foundation. Costs cover application hosting, managed database, professional email delivery, and domain name registration. All USD figures are converted at 1 USD = 600 XAF.

1. ITEMISED ANNUAL BUDGET

#	Component	Provider	Monthly (USD)	Monthly (XAF)	Annual (XAF)
1	Application Hosting	Railway — Hobby Plan	\$5.00	3,000	36,000
2	Managed Database (PostgreSQL)	Railway — Database Add-on	\$5.00	3,000	36,000
3	Professional Email Delivery	Resend — Pro Plan	\$20.00	12,000	144,000
4	Domain Name (.com)	Namecheap / GoDaddy	\$1.17	700	8,400
5	SSL / HTTPS Certificate	Let's Encrypt (auto via Railway)	FREE	FREE	FREE
6	Static Files & Media Serving	WhiteNoise (built into app)	FREE	FREE	FREE
TOTAL ANNUAL COST			\$31.17	18,700	224,400

2. WHAT EACH COMPONENT DOES

1. Application Hosting — Railway Hobby Plan (\$5/month)

Railway is the cloud platform that runs the AEF HRM web application 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. It keeps the system accessible to all staff at all times, handles incoming requests (login, leave applications, appraisals, PDF downloads), and automatically redeploys the latest version each time the developer pushes an update. The Hobby plan ensures the application never sleeps or goes offline during working hours.

2. Managed Database — Railway PostgreSQL (\$5/month)

The database stores all system data: employee records, leave requests and balances, appraisal results and scores, discipline records, contracts, notifications, and user accounts. Railway manages backups, security, and uptime automatically. Without the database the system cannot function. The add-on provides 1 GB of storage which is more than sufficient for an organisation of 50–200 staff.

3. Professional Email Delivery — Resend Pro (\$20/month)

The system sends automated emails for every key event: new employee onboarding (welcome email with login credentials), leave request approvals and rejections, appraisal stage notifications (when it is your turn to fill), contract alerts, and password resets. Resend Pro supports up to 50,000 emails per month and guarantees delivery through verified sending domains, preventing emails from landing in spam. A professional email service is essential for staff to trust and use the system reliably.

4. Domain Name (~\$1.17/month — billed annually at ~\$14/year)

A domain name gives the system a professional and memorable web address such as hrm.aef-cameroon.org or aef-hrm.com instead of a technical URL. Staff access the system by typing the domain in their browser. The domain is registered once per year through a domain registrar (Namecheap or GoDaddy). First-year promotions often reduce the cost to under \$2; standard renewal is \$10–\$15/year.



5. SSL / HTTPS Certificate (FREE)

SSL encrypts all data transmitted between staff browsers and the server, ensuring that passwords, appraisal scores, and personal records cannot be intercepted. Railway issues and renews SSL certificates automatically at no charge through Let's Encrypt. The padlock icon in the browser confirms the connection is secure.

6. Static Files & Media Serving (FREE)

CSS stylesheets, JavaScript, icons, and the company logo are served directly by the application using WhiteNoise, a library already integrated into the system. This eliminates the need for a separate CDN or file storage subscription, keeping the total cost as low as possible.

3. PAYMENT SCHEDULE

Frequency	Item	Payment	USD	XAF
Monthly Recurring	Railway (Hosting + Database)	Card / Bank Transfer	\$10.00 / month	6,000 XAF / month
Monthly Recurring	Resend (Email Delivery)	Card / Bank Transfer	\$20.00 / month	12,000 XAF / month
Annual (once/year)	Domain Name Renewal	Card / Bank Transfer	~\$14.00 / year	~8,400 XAF / year

4. BUDGET SUMMARY

Total Monthly Cost (USD)	\$31.17 / month
Total Monthly Cost (XAF)	18,700 XAF / month
Total Annual Cost (USD)	\$374.04 / year
Total Annual Cost (XAF)	224,400 XAF / year

TOTAL ANNUAL INVESTMENT:
224,400 XAF / year (\$374.04)

Note: All prices above are based on current provider rates as at April 2026. Railway and Resend pricing may be subject to change — the figures above should be treated as indicative. The system is already configured and integrated with Railway (hosting), Railway PostgreSQL (database), and Resend (email). No additional developer setup costs are required to activate these services. Payment is made directly to each provider by the organisation via credit/debit card or bank transfer.

APPROVED BY

Prepared by (Developer)

Name: _____

Sign: _____

Date: _____

Reviewed by (HR)

Name: _____

Sign: _____

Date: _____

Approved by (Management)

Name: _____

Sign: _____

Date: _____